Lairs

Lair grades, hoards, where they are placed, how they are named, ritual sites and what each grade yields

Kingdoms Call reference sheet. Data file v2026.10.15-1202. Generated 2026-10-19 from the repository (branch at that date). Numbers are what the engine uses today, read straight from its tables; where a figure comes from the rulebook text instead, the section says so.

Lairs are guarded treasure sites on land and sea. Every lair has one guardian of a grade (Weak, Moderate, Powerful, Legendary), a fixed hoard of gold and exactly one magic item of that grade. Clearing them is the main source of hero hit points and items. Ritual sites are lairs with no guardian, used by Pagan rites.

What to look for when reviewing

- The reward ladder per grade: gold, item tier, HP band of the guardian, rumour price, steal penalty.
- Placement: 60/30/10 near home, Legendary lairs as far apart as the map allows, always 22 of them.
- What each item tier holds by role (R-051): Weak lairs never hold combat kit.
- Naming: category pools on land and sea, plus signature names for the great Legendary powers.

Where this comes from

- Data file: LAIR_POOLS_CAT_P, LAIR_POOLS_MONSTER_P, KC_RUMOUR_COST_BY_POWER. Engine: ENCOUNTER_CLEAR_GOLD_BANDS, LAIR_ITEM_ODDS, ITEM_TIER_TARGET, STEAL_TIER_PEN, GUARDIAN_MELEE_BASE, RITUAL_SITE_NAMES, LAIR_EFFECT_SPREAD, world/generate.js.
- Rulebook: Lairs, Monsters & Treasure; Hunting Rumours; Ritual sites. Rulings R-001, R-008, R-011, R-051, R-052, R-072, R-108.

The four grades

Grade	Gold	Item	Guardian HP	Guardian blow	Perks	Rumours	Steal penalty	Guardian kinds	The hero it is cut for	That hero wins
Weak	5–8	Tier 1 (field and office kit, nothing that helps in a fight)	11–17	1–3 + Melee	1	1g	−0%	39	15 HP, no items, Melee 3 / Archery 2 (five points): a starting hero after a little training	about 19 in 20
Moderate	12–18	Tier 2 (first rung of arms, armour, potions, school +1)	19–25	2–5 + Melee	2	2g	−15%	35	~30 HP, no fighting items, Melee 5–6 and a school at 3–4: after six to eight Weak lairs	about half (nine in ten for a Powerful-row hero)
Powerful	20–30	Tier 3 (second rung: +3 weapons, +2 rings, crowns, wards)	32–42	3–7 + Melee	3	3g	−30%	26	~45 HP, a full set of Moderate items, Melee 7 and a school at 5–6: after six to eight Moderate lairs	about one in five (four in five for a Legendary-row hero)
Legendary	40–60	Tier 4 (one of the 22 relics)	53–65	4–9 + Melee	4	4g	−45%	10	~60 HP, a full set of Powerful items, Melee 9 and a school at 7–8: after about six Powerful lairs	about one in three

Rules

Rule	What it is
One item, always	Every lair holds exactly one magic item, of the guardian's own grade, decided when the world is made. A hoard is never empty; once the treasury of a tier is spent a Weak lair takes any utility item of any tier, and combat kit only when nothing else is left.

Rule	What it is
Fixed hoard	Gold and item are fixed at generation. Hunting Rumours reports them exactly, and whether a thief has been through. A slain challenger's kit joins the hoard.
Near home	In and around the home provinces about 60% Weak, 30% Moderate, 10% Powerful (R-001). Every home province holds a Weak lair and never a Legendary one. Further out, fewer Weak and more Moderate and Powerful; the deep wilds are almost all dangerous.
Legendary	Always 22 Legendary lairs in a world, so always the 22 relics, set as far apart as the map allows. A relic can never be stolen from a lair; only the guardian's defeat yields it.
Effects spread	Lairs within 3 provinces of each other never hold the same item effect while the treasury has another choice (R-052).
Unique per province	No province holds two lairs of the same base name, nor two of the same guardian (R-108).
Who wields the hoard	Humanoids, the intelligent undead, giants and fiends use the hoard's weapons and potions against you; fey and dragons wear only its trinkets; beasts, vermin, constructs, elementals and aberrations use nothing (R-011).
Thieves	The Steal tactic lifts 10% of the original gold per Thief level (to 5) and one item at 30% + 10%/level (cap 80%), less the grade penalty above; never a relic.
Hunting Rumours	Pay the grade's price per lair to learn the guardian's weakness (kept for that kind of creature for the rest of the game), the exact hoard, and your own odds in five bands (the world fights the lair many times in the background).
Sea lairs	Found at sea as on land; the sea-themed guardians are listed on the Guardians sheet. A strong navy opens them.
Kinds of creature	Humanoid, undead, beast, vermin, giant, dragon, fiend, fey, aberration, elemental, construct. The kind decides Holy Symbol (×1.5 on undead and fiends), hoard use, and whether a Druid reads the animal (beasts and vermin only).

Item stock per tier, by kind and role (ITEM_TIER_TARGET: utility / combat)

Tier	Trinket	Ring	Amulet	Cloak	Helm	Weapon	Armour	Shield	Combat	Total
Weak	90 / 0	50 / 0	40 / 0	40 / 0	40 / 0	12 / 0	12 / 0	4 / 0	0 / 0	288
Moderate	12 / 12	8 / 16	5 / 20	5 / 20	5 / 20	2 / 30	2 / 36	0 / 30	0 / 70	293
Powerful	4 / 6	2 / 8	2 / 8	2 / 8	2 / 8	1 / 25	0 / 10	0 / 10	0 / 12	108
Legendary	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	22 named relics

Each tier is sized so the largest map does not run short (a ten-realm map seats about 240 Weak lairs). Within a tier every kind is dealt evenly, region by region, and a find made in play is drawn from whichever kind that realm has seen least of.

Ritual sites

Rule	What it is
Names	Standing Stones, Blood Altar, Circle of the Old Gods
Where	Every wild (Creature or Monster) land province holds one (both rites possible); about a quarter of humanoid land provinces hold one (Blood Offering only). Placed only when a Pagan realm is in the game; a Pagan home always borders a wild forest or jungle province with one.
Rules	No guardian, never cleared, discovered by exploration like any lair. One rite per province per turn, by anyone (R-008). Only Pagan realms can use them.

Lair names by guardian category

Category	Land names	Sea names
Humanoid	Bandit Stronghold, Robbers’ Roost, Palisade Camp, Hilltop Warcamp, Raiders’ Stockade, Smuggler’s Bolthole, Cutthroat’s Hideaway, Broken Watchtower, Slaver’s Compound, Painted Skull Camp, Turncoat’s Redoubt, Warband Muster, Thieves’ Undercroft, Bloodied Toll-Post	Wreckers’ Cove, Smuggler’s Inlet, Pirate Anchorage, Blackflag Careenage, Reef Raiders’ Haven, Salt-Rot Jetty, Drowned Man’s Landing

Category	Land names	Sea names
Undead	Old Graveyard, Barrow of the Nameless, Weeping Crypt, Bone Orchard, Plague Village, Cairn of Ash, Sunken Mausoleum, Charnel Vault, Hollow Sepulchre, Grave-Mound of the Fallen, Ossuary of Grey Hands, Silent Necropolis, Field of Unquiet Dead, Tomb of the Long Sleep	Ghost Anchorage, Drowned Graveyard, Rotting Hulk, Corpse-Light Shoal, Bone Reef, Sunken Burial Fleet, Grave of a Thousand Sails
Beast	Wolf Den, Blood-Slick Warren, Bone-Strewn Lair, Hunting Ground, Predator's Thicket, Gnawed Hollow, Carcass Pit, Beast Track, Rutting Hollow, Torn Earth Burrow, Ravening Covert, Kill-Ground of Old Claws	Feeding Shoal, Bloodied Shallows, Bone-Picked Reef, Hunting Waters, Silt-Choked Trench, Torn Net Grounds
Vermin	Crawling Nest, Web-Choked Hollow, Chitin Burrow, Swarm Mound, Rotting Midden, Hive Warren, Skittering Undercroft, Egg-Clotted Pit, Verminous Sinkhole, Chittering Deep	Swarm Shoal, Barnacle Wreck, Stinging Shallows, Clotted Tidepool, Crawling Reef
Giant	Boulder Hall, Giant's Steps, Crushing Deep, Cyclopean Ruin, Stone-Piled Hold, Titan's Seat, Cracked Menhir Ring, Hall of Broken Pillars, Grinding Quarry, Skull-Heap Camp	Wading Shallows, Pillar Rocks, Giant's Causeway, Sea-Stack Hold, Trawler's Doom
Dragon	Dragon Hoard, Scorched Eyrie, Cinder Cavern, Glittering Wyrm-Hoard, Ash-Choked Roost, Molten Throat, Scale-Strewn Cave, Smoking Crag, Serpent's Coil	Drowned Wyrm-Hoard, Boiling Trench, Coil of the Deep, Scoured Sea-Cave, Serpent Reef
Fiend	Blood Altar, Sulphur Rift, Circle of Black Candles, Screaming Chapel, Brimstone Fissure, Pact Stone, Chapel of Broken Saints, Wound in the World, Pit of Whispered Bargains	Drowned Chapel, Black-Water Rift, Pact Reef, Boiling Brimstone Vent
Fey	Faerie Ring, Whispering Grove, Toadstool Court, Glamour-Wood, Thorn Bower, Moonlit Dell, Mirror Pool, Court of Pale Lanterns, Wildering Path	Siren Rocks, Singing Shoal, Moonwake Reef, Drowned Faerie Ring, Pale Lantern Cove
Aberration	Wrong Hollow, Fleshwarped Grotto, Pit of Staring Eyes, Impossible Chamber, Whispering Sinkhole, Chamber of Wrong Angles	Abyssal Trench, Sunless Deep, Grasping Kelp Forest, Lightless Chasm, Coil-Marked Shelf, Silent Fathoms
Elemental	Whirling Waste, Ember Fissure, Storm-Scarred Bluff, Cinder Vortex, Riven Stone Circle, Screaming Updraught	Squall Reef, Whirlpool Mouth, Storm-Torn Shoal, Boiling Vent
Construct	Silent Foundry, Hall of Still Guardians, Clockwork Ruin, Cold Forge, Rune-Cut Gatehouse, Workshop of the Long-Dead	Sunken Foundry, Rune-Cut Sea Gate, Drowned Workshop

Signature lairs of the great Legendary powers

Guardian	Its lair names
Elder Dragon	Hoard of the Elder Wyrm, The Cindered Peak, Vault of Melted Gold, Throat of the Mountain
Ancient Wyrm	Barrow of the Ancient Wyrm, The Slagged Halls, Nest of Blackened Bone, Hoard Beneath the Roots
Dracolich	Crypt of the Bone Wyrm, Hoard of Cold Ashes, The Rattling Vault, Sepulchre of Scale and Dust
Lich Sovereign	Black Spire of the Sovereign, Phylactery Vault, Hall of the Deathless Crown, The Sleepless Library
Dread Vampire Sovereign	Castle of the Red Watch, Crypt of the Crimson Throne, Hall of a Thousand Coffins, The Bloodless Keep
Archdemon	The Riven Gate, Throne of Burning Oaths, Cathedral of the Broken Seal, Pit of the Last Bargain
Elder Titan	Seat of the Elder Titan, Bones of the World-Builder, The Colossus Steps, Hall Where Mountains Sat
Storm Titan	Anvil of the Storm, Cloudbreak Summit, Hall of Rolling Thunder, The Sky-Struck Crag
Sphinx	Riddle Gate, Hall of the Unanswered Question, Sunken Sphinx Court, Tomb of Seven Riddles
Kraken	The Devouring Deep, Coil-Marked Abyss, Graveyard of Whole Fleets, Maw Beneath the Charts
Vampire Lord	Red Chapel, Coffin Hall, Manor of Shuttered Windows, Crypt of Pale Hands
Death Knight	Barrow of the Black Oath, Hall of the Broken Vow, Tomb of the Iron Vigil
Bone Colossus	Cairn of Piled Dead, The Heaped Ossuary, Mound of Ten Thousand Bones
Banshee	Weeping Tower, Hollow of Endless Grief, The Keening Barrow
Medusa	Garden of Statues, Hall of Staring Stone, Court of the Petrified
Chimera	Three-Throated Cave, Beast-Maker's Ruin, Lair of Mismatched Bones
Stone Golem	Hall of Still Guardians, The Rune-Cut Gate, Mason's Silent Workshop

Guardian	Its lair names
Night Hag	Cottage of Bad Dreams, The Nightmare Thicket, Hut on Crooked Legs
Greater Demon	Cathedral of Smoke, The Screaming Rift, Altar of the Bound Name
Chaos Knight	Broken Tournament Ground, Chapel of the Turned Blade, Field of Rusted Lances
Orc Warlord	Skull-Post Warcamp, The War-Drum Hill, Stockade of Piled Shields
Frost Giant Jarl	Ice-Hall of the Jarl, The Frozen Mead-Hall, Glacier Seat
Hill Giant Chieftain	Boulder-Ring Camp, The Cracked Hill Hold, Chieftain’s Bone-Heap
Rock Giant	Quarry of Slow Hands, The Standing Scree, Hall of Piled Stone
Pirate Captain	Blackflag Anchorage, Hidden Careenage, Cove of Split Colours
Ghost Galleon Crew	The Drowned Galleon, Anchorage of Cold Lanterns, Wreck of the Last Watch
Drowned Admiral	Grave of the Flagship, Sunken Admiralty, Fleet Beneath the Fleet
Deep One Priest	Temple Beneath the Tide, The Scaled Chancel, Drowned Sanctum
Abyssal Horror	The Sunless Chasm, Where the Charts End, Trench of Staring Dark
Kraken Spawn	Coil-Marked Shelf, Nursery of the Deep, Grasping Kelp Wood
Deep Leviathan	The Long Trench, Bones of Whole Whales, Deep Where Nothing Sings
Sea Wyrm	Boiling Coil, Reef of Shed Scales, Serpent’s Drowned Hoard
Giant Octopus	Ink-Dark Grotto, The Grasping Wreck, Eight-Armed Shelf
Storm Eagle	Cloudbreak Eyrie, The Thunder Roost, Wind-Scoured Crag
Acid Wyvern	Etched Hollow, Roost of Pitted Stone, The Melting Cliff
Marsh Hydra	Nine-Headed Fen, The Regrown Mire, Bog of Severed Necks

A name is never repeated in the world; when a pool runs dry the lair takes a place-qualified form ("Wolf Den beneath Karnholt").

Gaps, questions and things to check

These are observations from reading the data files, the engine and the rulebook together. None of them is a ruling. Each is a question for Toby or a place where two sources disagree.

#	Observation
1	Legendary gold (40–60) is about four times Moderate (12–18) for a fight the benchmark hero wins one time in three; the relic and the HP roll are the real prize. Say whether gold should matter more at the top.
2	Moderate lairs are the hard step: the benchmark hero wins about half, where Weak is 19 in 20 and Powerful one in five. The ladder is not even.
3	Guardian kinds per grade: Weak 39, Moderate 35, Powerful 26, Legendary 10. Ten Legendary guardians for 22 Legendary lairs means each kind appears about twice per world.
4	Steal penalties (−15/30/45 by grade) give a Thief 3 hero 80% against a Weak hoard but 35% against a Legendary one; a Thief 5 Cowardly hero with Invisibility still reaches 85% there. Say whether a relic-guarding lair should be that open to a master thief's gold.
5	Two lair-naming systems remain (see the Terrain sheet). The terrain-named sites include guardians such as "Sand Drake" and "Sphinx" that match no guardian in MONSTERS_P.
6	R-001 is confirmed but has no test; the 60/30/10 split is the kind of thing a seeded test can hold.
7	The sea guardians are a fixed set of names; a sea lair never holds a land guardian. Check the sea has every grade well represented (see the Guardians sheet).